

"A church *in*, for but not of the world"

An Introduction To CPC

Class Objective: The class will provide a general introduction to CPC, and especially our way of thinking about the gospel and the church. Therefore, even as this class will be a general introduction to CPC, it will necessarily include a primer in what has been described as an "evangelical and reformed" theology as this is translated into specific core values, visions and strategies pertaining to our ministry in New Haven. The class is designed for people in all stages of the Christian experience- from the generally curious unbeliever to the long time disciple of Christ seeking to understand the gospel as it is being experienced and communicated at CPC! IT is therefore recommended to anyone who has not yet taken this class, both those who presently are, and those who are not, members at CPC.

Time and Place:

Sunday Mornings: 9:50-10:45 am
Balcony Area (College Room)

Class Schedule:

- ❖ January 18 Module #1: CPC's Core Values in Ministry
Suggested Reading:
 Centrality of the Gospel, Tim Keller
 What is a Christian, Preston Graham
 Is Church Membership Important?, Preston Graham

Scripture Reading:
 To Know Christ: The Gospel According to John
 To Understand the Church: The Letter to the Ephesians

- ❖ February 1 Module #2: CPC's Five Basic Commitments in Ministry
Suggested Reading: *Covenantal Worship*, Preston Graham

- ❖ February 8 Module #3: CPC's Reformed and Presbyterian Distinctiveness
Suggested Readings: *Faith Unfolded*, *A Fresh Look At the Reformed Faith*, Jim Osterhouse
 A Baptism that Saves, Preston Graham

- ❖ February 15 Module #4: CPC And The Kingdom of God
To be discussed:
 - a. A kingdom that is NOW and NOT YET
 - b. The Church and the Kingdom of God
 - c. Church and State
 - d. Church and Para-Church

- ❖ February 22 Module #5: CPC and Basic Christianity
To be discussed: (Some Readings available on Internet)
 - a. What is a Christian?
 - b. Is Church Membership Important?
 - c. How Then Do We Live As A Christian? (Basic Discipleship and Calling)
 - d. How do I become a member at CPC?

Class Resources:

- ✓ *New Members Packet* (Includes: PCA Manual for New Members, PCA Brochure, Westminster Confession of Faith (w/out scripture references), Ministry Connection 2003-2004, CPC directory, CPC Programs, Church Prayer Guide)
- ✓ Internet posted Study Guides/Handouts (www.christpresnewhaven.org)
- ✓ Further Readings:
 - CPC Position Papers (see "book table" in Foyer and Internet)
 - See also Pastor's Book Guide